

EVIDENCE · CANVAS · SERIES

word-cloud

Spiral-packed word cloud — items sized by weight.

What 38 win/loss interviews kept saying, by frequency.



What this branch named, by weight.

A word cloud constellation diagram where words are arranged in a circular pattern. The words are: 'function' (purple, top), 'gallery' (small, top right), 'form' (purple, right), 'manifest' (blue, bottom right), 'substance' (small, bottom left), and 'component' (blue, left). The words are connected by thin lines, forming a circular path.

function
gallery
component form
substance
manifest

Every term this branch touched.



What this branch named, by weight.



The one word that defined the branch.

A word cloud visualization with the word "variants" as the central, largest term in a bold blue font. Surrounding it are four other words: "gallery" in a smaller, dark red font above, "manifest" in a smaller, olive green font to the right, "declared" in a very small, grey font to the left, and "docs" in a very small, grey font below.

gallery

declared

variants

manifest

docs

Stress test — 20 terms, raw frequency counts (512 → 5).



What 38 win/loss interviews kept saying, by frequency.



What 38 win/loss interviews kept saying, by frequency.



What 38 win/loss interviews kept saying, by frequency.



When NOT to reach for word-cloud.

Precise comparisons. If the audience needs to know that 'manifest' is 1.6× 'function', the spiral packing actively misleads. Use `progress` or a bar chart where the eye can compare lengths directly.

Two or three words. A three-word cloud is a list with extra steps. Use `stats` for a metric row or `big-number` for a single weighted headline.

Multi-word phrases. Each li should be a single token. Multi-word phrases blow out the layout and crowd the spiral; if your data is phrases, normalise to keywords first or use `quote` for verbatim text.

See also.

RELATED COMPONENTS

`progress` — the weights need precise visual comparison

`stats` — the headline metrics are independent numbers, not a corpus

`piechart` — the items are parts of a whole, not free-form themes

`quote` — the verbatim language matters more than the frequency

`tldr` — the qualitative summary is prose, not a packed cloud